

products which we purchase from the market to replace the older models of components,” says Zaveri. But what happens when the RMA stock gets depleted? “This happens very rarely and mainly in the case of processors”, says Subramaniam. “The customer can opt for a newer model for which he has to pay a marginal difference (which usually works out to a couple of hundred rupees) between the current prices of the older and newer model. If the price difference isn’t too much then we sometimes pay the difference.”

Beware, O buyer

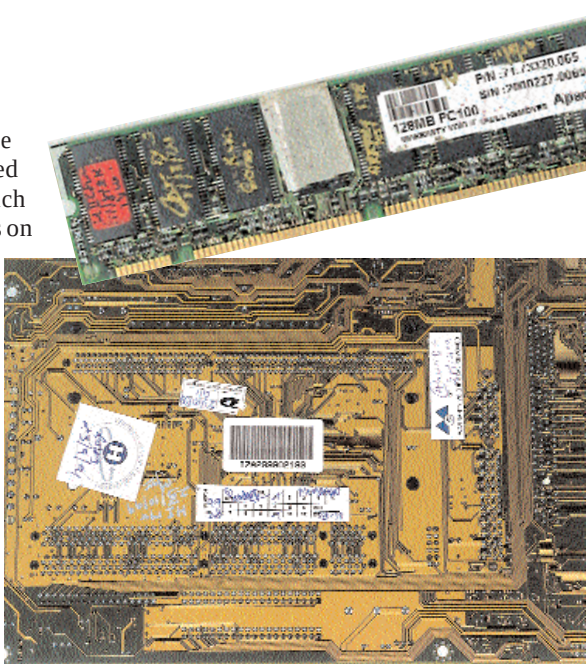
There are many fly-by-night operators who’ll promise you an assembled PC at dirt-cheap rates. Dealing with them normally ends up proving expensive in the long run when your computer breaks down before the warranty period. “Most people don’t understand this and compromise on product support to save money,” says Varsha Bapat of Computer Track, a Compaq dealer.

You’re always at an advantage when you purchase your system from a reputed dealer even if it means paying a marginally higher price. You get an assurance that your warranty will be honoured. Most reputed dealers also have a good, long-standing relationship with the vendor. So in case of a problem, you’ll get your replacement

quickly. “Make sure the dealer is well-established and check for how much money the dealer spends on advertising and being visible,” says Subramaniam. A lot depends on the relationship you have with your assembler. A number of hardware buyers we spoke to said that they trusted their dealers to honour the warranty.

It’s your call

Computer warranties aren’t all that well streamlined and don’t follow any clear-cut policy. And there are shady dealers out to get you. But if you are well informed and do your homework, you can spot a fly-by-night operator a mile away. And make sure you don’t compromise on product support. Remember—caveat emptor: Let the hardware buyer beware!



Top: Look out for signatures on the RAM to ensure that you are not getting a second hand piece

Above: When you send your motherboard for servicing, how do you know you are getting your own motherboard back? Just flip it and check for these stickers